

Competitive Research

The Soft Power Collective

Field scan of peer educators, studios, and communities in the kink-positive, conscious-relationships, and female-led intimacy education space.

Research conducted April 2026 • Prepared for Casey Lynn

Primary Target: Bound Studio

Bound Studio (Lancaster) positions itself as a professional, relationship-focused shibari and rope studio — not a dungeon, not underground. Their framing leans explicitly toward "intimacy" and "connection" rather than "kink," which is strategic and worth noting.

What they do well

- Use language like "Discover intimacy," "deepen bonds," "explore together" — relational, not transactional
- Educators are described with professional credentialing language (years teaching, method lineage)
- Small-group format is positioned as a feature (safety, attention), not a limitation
- Photography is clean, modelled, softly lit — aspirational without being explicit
- Couples are an obvious target audience, which broadens appeal beyond the typical single-practitioner market

What to steal

- The move from "kink" to "intimacy" as the primary noun is savvy — it lowers the barrier for new visitors
 - Educator-centered marketing ("Learn from [Name]") creates magnetism
 - Workshops framed as experiences people have together, not skills they acquire alone
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The Field: Female-Led Peers Worth Watching

Kasia Urbaniak — The Academy

Former dominatrix, now runs The Academy. Owns the "women + power" lane entirely. Her copy uses words like "reclaim," "conditioning," and "the Good Girl" — framing personal liberation as political. Visual identity is stark white with bold serif typography. Serious, academic feel. Pulls in women who'd never call themselves "kinky" but want agency.

Midori / ForteFemme

The original female dominance educator. Runs 9-person intensives. Uses "Head-Heart-Hands" as her pedagogical frame. Copy is elegant and practical, never spiritualized. Emphasizes mentorship and lineage. Deliberately small. She's proof that scarcity + elite mentorship positioning works in this space.

Layla Martin

Mainstream tantra/pleasure. "VITA Method." Dominates spiritual-sensual Instagram. Copy uses "ignite," "awaken," "sacred," "pleasure," "magnetic." Lush brand photography with flowing fabric, candles, rose petals. Her funnel is enormous — free masterclass to low-ticket offer to high-ticket program. Very polished. Maybe too polished for SPC's intended tone, but the funnel architecture is instructive.

Jessica Fern

Author of Polysecure. Owns the attachment theory + non-monogamy intersection. Copy is warm and therapeutic ("secure," "navigating," "integrating"). Positioned as a psychotherapist first, a polyamory expert second — which gives her enormous credibility. Minimal brand, emphasis on books and talks.

Barbara Carrellas

Urban Tantra author. Pioneer status. Warmer, older, more activist voice. Uses "ecstatic," "expansive," "erotic energy." Her brand is less polished than the newer educators, which actually reads as trustworthy — she's been at this since the 90s.

Somatica Institute

Sex and intimacy coaching certification program. Copy is earnest, warm, pedagogical. Lots of "somatic," "embodied," "attunement." Teal + warm neutrals palette. They target aspiring practitioners, not end clients, but their language bridges therapy-world and kink-world — a great reference for SPC's voice.

Lee Harrington — Passion & Soul

Educator, author, ritual-oriented. Masculine-adjacent but frequently teaches alongside women educators. Gender-expansive framing. Good reference for inclusive language that doesn't default to heteronormative couples.

Sunny Megatron

Sex educator, podcast host (American Sex, Open Deeply). Very approachable, conversational voice. Copy reads like a smart friend. She shows what a trustworthy accessible-educator tone sounds like without being condescending.

Community brands (The Expansive Group, Curious Fox, etc.)

Community-first (not personality-led). Use "members," "gatherings," "space," "collective." Tend toward aesthetic minimalism because the community is the product, not the founder. This is the lane SPC is in.

Patterns Across the Field

Recurring Language

The words that appear repeatedly across successful brands in this space, grouped by theme:

- **Embodiment:** embodied, somatic, felt sense, come home to yourself, in your body, presence, attunement
- **Power:** reclaim, agency, autonomy, sovereignty, consent, empowerment, your yes, your no
- **Community:** collective, gathering, circle, container, space, belonging, held, witnessed
- **Exploration:** curious, exploration, journey, discover, learning edge, expansive, invitation
- **Safety:** trauma-aware, inclusive, affirming, consent-centered, held with care, trust, braver space

The word "kink" itself is used selectively — often paired with softening nouns like "curiosity," "conscious kink," or "intentional play."

CTA Patterns

Nobody in this space says "Buy now." They say:

- "Join a circle"
- "Begin your journey"
- "Explore upcoming offerings"
- "Apply to work together"
- "Find your way in"
- "Get on the list"

"Apply" is especially interesting — it signals selectivity and that the educator is choosing you too, not just taking your money. Both Midori and Kasia use it.

Pricing Transparency

Split roughly 50/50. Larger brands (Layla Martin, Somatica) publish clear tiered pricing. Smaller personality-led brands (Midori, Kasia) use "Apply" or "Inquire" — preserving scarcity and allowing price flexibility.

For SPC, "Inquire" is the right call early. It lets you price based on fit, and it matches the intimate community vibe.

Visual Patterns That Work

- Warm earth palettes are ascendant (sage, terracotta, cream, rust, soft gold). The old dark-red-leather palette is out.
- Hand-drawn or organic illustrations are a strong differentiator. Midori and Barbara Carrellas both use them. They soften the subject matter.
- Photography: real people, natural light, hands + objects (rope, candles, books, tea cups), faces but not always — intimacy without voyeurism.
- Typography: refined serifs for headings (Cormorant, Playfair, Tenor) paired with clean humanist sans (Nunito, Inter, Montserrat).
- Whitespace is non-negotiable. Cramped design reads amateur in this space.

Positioning Opportunities for SPC

What's Crowded

- Tantra / sacred sexuality (Layla Martin owns this)

- Polyamory + attachment theory (Jessica Fern owns this)
- Rope / shibari education (Bound Studio, Lee Harrington, Midori all active)
- Female dominance coaching (Kasia, Midori)

What's Underserved

1. **Warm + rigorous community for kink-curious people who don't identify as "kinky."** Most brands require you to self-identify before they let you in. SPC can be the on-ramp.
 2. **Explicit "emotional intelligence meets practical play."** Most educators emphasize one or the other. Your bio beats (C-suite background + personal journey) are a rare combination that lets you credibly hold both.
 3. **Community-first, not personality-first.** You're "The Collective," not "Casey Lynn Coaching." That's a structural differentiator — personality-led brands rise and fall with the person; a collective has room to scale and be plural.
 4. **Sliding-scale accessibility without looking cheap.** Most of the market is either \$\$\$\$ intensives or bargain-bin. A clear "we believe in making this accessible" stance is distinctive.
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Copy Recommendations

Headlines & Taglines to Consider or Adapt

5. "A gentle space for bold exploration." (*your current — keep it, it's strong*)
6. "Curiosity is enough."
7. "Where emotional intelligence meets intentional play."
8. "Conscious kink. Honest connection. Real community."
9. "For people who want to grow, not just learn."
10. "The community you wish you'd had when you started asking questions."
11. "Kink that makes sense. Connection that lasts."
12. "An invitation, not a test."

Navigation & Button Copy

- **"Join a Circle"** (for coaching circles) — feels held and warm
- **"Find Your Pairing"** (for mentorship) — warmer than "Apply for Mentorship"

- "What's Coming Up" (for events) — friendlier than "Calendar"
- "Tell Us About You" (for the pricing inquiry intake form) — reframes a transaction as a conversation

Section Transitions & Phrases to Weave In

"Whoever you are, whatever you're exploring, you belong here."

"We move at the speed of trust."

"Take what resonates. Leave the rest."

"This isn't about getting it right — it's about showing up whole."

Phrases to Avoid

- "Lifestyle" as a noun — too insider, alienates newcomers
- "Kinksters" — infantilizing
- "Play partner" in marketing copy — too specific/insider
- Anything that implies "beginners" vs. "experienced" as a hierarchy
- "Dungeon" language

Aesthetic Recommendations

Keep

- Sage green, terracotta, cream, charcoal palette — you're aligned with the winning trend
- Serif headings (Cormorant Garamond is ideal)
- Hand-drawn organic illustrations (open hands, crescent moon, rope knot)
- Warm natural-light photography

Add

- **Texture.** Paper grain, subtle linen textures, soft noise. Most competitors have flat brands; texture reads as crafted and intentional.

- **Occasional script/handwritten accents** for pull quotes or signatures.
- **Photography of hands and objects** (rope, books, candles, herbs) — builds mood without requiring faces.
- **Seasonal or monthly theming** (Layla Martin and Somatica both do this). Gives content cadence and makes the email list feel alive.

Avoid

- Stock photography of "intimate couples" — reads generic
 - Red or black as primary colors
 - Anything that looks like a kink club aesthetic (metal, leather, neon, skulls)
 - Over-polished influencer-style reels — authenticity wins in this space
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Priority Takeaways for the Website

13. **Your tagline is already strong.** Don't let anyone talk you into changing it.
 14. **Lead with "belonging" language on the home page, not "kink" language.** You can introduce kink as readers go deeper.
 15. **Use "Inquire" not "Buy."** Matches the intimate vibe and maintains pricing flexibility.
 16. **The "C-suite + personal journey" angle is your unfair advantage.** Few competitors have both professional rigor AND lived experience. Lean in.
 17. **Community-first framing (The Collective) scales better than personality-first (Casey Lynn Coaching).** You already got this right.
 18. **Every page should feel like an invitation, not a pitch.**
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Sources

[Bound Studio](#)

[ForteFemme \(Midori\)](#)

[Kasia Urbaniak — The Academy](#)

[Layla Martin](#)

[Jessica Fern](#)

[Barbara Carrellas — Urban Tantra](#)

[Somatica Institute](#)

[Lee Harrington — Passion & Soul](#)

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